



SOCIAL WORKER

JOB DESCRIPTION

For those committed to creating positive changes in people's lives, social work can be a rewarding career. Social workers provide help, support, and advice to vulnerable people in the community. They work closely with agencies, such as schools, hospitals, and probation services, to recommend ways in which struggling members of society can improve their lives.



SALARY

Bachelor's level social worker ★★★★★
Licensed clinical social worker ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Large number of employment opportunities • Growing demand for social workers due to an aging population • Majority of work in the public sector

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Sociology • Health and social service • Psychology • Child care and development • Helping and caring for people



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree in social work or a related field is required. Some jobs require a master's degree and accreditation by a professional body.



LIFESTYLE Many full-time social workers have normal office hours, but others can have nontraditional schedules. Part-time jobs are available.



LOCATION Although social workers work mostly from one location, they regularly visit clients at home or in schools and other community settings.



THE REALITIES Working with disadvantaged groups and making decisions that will affect a person's future can be emotionally challenging.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **PSYCHOLOGIST** *see pp. 254–255*
- ▶ **COUNSELOR** *see pp. 256–257*
- ▶ **OCCUPATIONAL THERAPIST** *see pp. 292–293*
- ▶ **FAMILY SUPPORT WORKER** A type of social worker who offers practical and emotional support to people who are experiencing problems in their personal lives, such as families going through divorce, people with disabilities, and children whose parents are in prison.
- ▶ **SUBSTANCE ABUSE COUNSELOR** Helps people overcome their dependence on alcohol and over-the-counter or illegal drugs, providing them with practical advice and referrals to specialty organizations to plan recovery and treatment programs.
- ▶ **YOUTH WORKER** A type of social worker who works with young people to promote personal, social, and educational development in their lives. Methods of support include counseling, mentoring, and arranging activities.